cooperation for promoting peace, stability and amity, and discussed the operation of SAARC in a changed international environment involving economic, technological, and social information. They also called for an acceleration of SAARC economic cooperation, and decided to adopt measures to remove structural impediments to speedily move towards the goal of SAFTA.

## Eleventh Summit: Kathmandu, 4–6 January 2002

After a long gap of 42 months, the Eleventh SAARC Summit was held in Kathmandu. The Summit tried to overcome the animosity between India and Pakistan due to increased military build-up of both the neighbours along the LOC (Line of Control) in Kashmir. The Summit resolved to move towards the achievement of the objective of promoting mutual cooperation for the development of the region. Regarding economic cooperation, the Heads of States and Governments recognized the need to move quickly towards SAFTA and they directed the Council of Ministers to finalize the text of the Draft Treaty Framework by the end of 2002. The Kathmandu Declaration called for an intensified coordination among South Asian states on all WTO issues. They stressed the need to intensify coordination among the SAARC missions in Geneva to begin the necessary preparation to advance the common interest of the region in the Fifth WTO Ministerial Conference. In the discussions in the Summit, along with other common concerns such as poverty alleviation, women and children, international political and economic environment, terrorism took the centre stage. The Heads of State and Governments also reiterated their support for the UN Security Council Resolution 1373 of 28 September 2001 and resolved to combat terrorism in all its manifestations. They reaffirmed their commitment to SAARC Regional Convention on Suppression of Terrorism.

## Twelfth SAARC Summit: Islamabad, 2–6 January 2004

The Heads of States and Governments resolved to accelerate the economic and trade cooperation among the members and ensure progress towards the realization of SAPTA and the emergence of SAFTA. It was agreed to complete the first level of SAFTA by 2006